

Blu-ray

All you need to know about Blu-ray:
<http://bit.ly/i8hUHP>

Optimus range

LG announces top-end Android smartphones
 for India - Optimus 2X and Optimus Black

Be the vigilant consumer

We tell you about the perils of IVRS activated services

Kapil Rustagi

readersletters@thinkdigit.com

Anu, a Delhi-based professional was taken aback on seeing her latest monthly telephone bill sky-rocketing. On close scrutiny, she realised she was charged almost ₹500 per month towards BlackBerry services. The interesting part is that she doesn't even own a BlackBerry, neither did she request for BlackBerry services. However surprising this may be, Anu's case is not an isolated one.

In these days of automation and interactive voice response systems (IVRS), you'll most definitely have received calls guiding you through a voice menu

that requires you to press a few buttons. Inadvertently, it's quite likely you would've pressed a few wrong keys. To add to consumers' agony, on complaining, the service provider hardly pays any heed to it. In the absence of any proof to substantiate their side of the story, consumers are rather rendered helpless. Non-payment penalties and threats of discontinuation of services add to the frustration, only adding to the profits of mobile service companies.

Complaints can be lodged with the respective nodal officer of the mobile service company. There are official guide-

lines issued by various judicial forums and the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) to curb the growing menace. Despite such restrictions and guidelines, companies through marketing agencies or otherwise use tactics to dupe consumers. You can lodge a complain against the erring service providers with TRAI as well. The web site of TRAI (trai.gov.in) is a useful resource to know about telecom issues and current guidelines issued for benefits of the consumer.

It is advisable not to subscribe to any added feature via marketing calls, as marketing agencies could activate additional features to earn their commission. Such services should prefer-

ably be activated from the authorised centres of the mobile service company to avoid any such untoward situation that you will have to deal with later. **[1]**



We can help!

If you're facing a problem with your purchase, write to us at help@consumermate.com

COMPLAINTS RECEIVED

Sony Ericsson Vivaz Pro malfunctioning

Question: I bought a new Sony Ericsson Vivaz Pro on December 23, 2010. Its standby time was pathetic and so I got the battery replaced at the showroom itself, on December 29, 2010. Later, I faced another problem - the phone happens to require charging twice a day and so I gave my mobile to Sony service centre in the month of January. After two days they rectified the problem (they say) and returned it back to me. After two or three weeks, I got a problem in voice quality and hanging. So on February 23, 2011 I gave it again to the service centre. Within two months, I encountered similar problems thrice. I need a solution for this, most likely a replacement. The cost of Mobile is ₹21,000. I can provide recent reference number for the service centre visits.

Contacted By: Bharani kumar

Dear Consumer,

I am presuming that this phone was sold to you on the condition, or the representation, that it would work for such time and in manner as you have explained. If that is the case, you can put a challenge to the dealer and the company. As stated by you in your complaint, this is a case where the product was having an inherent manufacturing problem. There are deficiencies in the service on the part of the dealer and the company. You have to take legal action to put them in motion. Do not feel cheated as you can very well take legal action by complaining in the district consumer forum. The thing which I can suggest at this stage is that in the first instance write a registered letter containing all the details of your complaint. In case they do not come up with a solution, then you may go ahead with complaint in the district forum. I hope some

sense will prevail over them at the stage of notice itself and they will sort out the things. And, yes maintain a record of communications which may be necessary in future as evidence. We understand that it may tough for you to go to consumer forum, but sometimes even filing the complaint is sufficient to move them.

My Nokia N97 is not working fine

Question: I bought a Nokia N97 in September 2010. Since then, I have visited Nokia Care several times regarding many problems, such as: low signal strength, no signal where other mobiles on same network get full coverage, battery drain, buttons not working. My software has been updated thrice and my batteries changed twice. I have maintained a record of the job sheet numbers. I need a replacement.

Contacted By: Ankur Nagpal